UNIT 22.2 · LEVEL B1

Past perfect continuous

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 She was tired because she _____ all day.

a) worked **b)** has been working **c)** had been working **d)** was work

2 They _____ for an hour when the bus finally came.

a) had been waiting **b)** have been waiting
c) were wait **d)** waits

3 How long _____ you been studying before the exam?

a) have **b)** did **c)** were **d)** had

4 The ground was wet. It _____ all night.

a) has been raining **b)** had been raining **c)** was rain **d)** is raining

5 Which sentence is correct?

a) He had been knowing her for years. **b)** He had known her for years.
c) He had been known her. **d)** He has been known her.

6 I _____ for two hours when she called.

a) have been cooking **b)** has been cooking
c) been cooking **d)** had been cooking

7 She _____ in London for five years before she moved.

a) had been living **b)** has lived **c)** had been live **d)** was live

8 Which sentence uses 'since' correctly?

a) He had been working since two hours.
b) He had been working since a long time.
c) He had been working since 8 a.m.
d) He had been working since ten minutes.

9 We were exhausted. We _____ for hours.

a) walk **b)** have been walking
c) are walking **d)** had been walking

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10 The past perfect continuous emphasises _____.

a) the duration of an action
b) a finished result
c) a future plan
d) a habit now

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 He was dirty because he _____ (play) in the mud.

12 We _____ been waiting for an hour when the doctor came.

13 She had been _____ (study) all night before the test.

14 How long had they _____ living there?

15 I had been working there _____ 2015 when they closed it.

16 They had been arguing _____ two hours.

17 It _____ been snowing for hours, so the roads were closed.

18 My eyes hurt because I _____ (read) all day.

19 Had you been _____ (wait) long when the bus arrived?

20 He _____ (not / sleep) well, so he was tired.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **she / had / been / waiting / for / an / hour**

_____

22 **they / had / been / playing / football / all / day**

_____

23 **how / long / had / you / been / waiting**

_____

24 **he / was / tired / because / he / had / been / running**

_____

25 **it / had / been / raining / all / night**

_____

26 **we / hadn't / been / sleeping / well**

_____

27 **I / had / been / working / since / seven**

_____

28 **had / she / been / crying**

_____

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Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the correct word.*
She was tired because she _____ all day.
Options: **has been working** / **was work** / **had been working** / **works**

30 *Choose the correct word.*
They _____ for an hour when it started to rain.
Options: **had been walking** / **have been walking** / **were walk** / **walks**

31 *Choose the correct word.*
How long _____ you been waiting?
Options: **did** / **have** / **had** / **are**

32 *Choose the correct word.*
He had been working here _____ 2010 when he left.
Options: **since** / **for** / **ago** / **during**

33 *Choose the correct word.*
I _____ studying for two hours when you called.
Options: **have been** / **had been** / **was been** / **has been**

34 *Choose the correct word.*
We had been waiting _____ an hour.
Options: **since** / **ago** / **during** / **for**

35 *Choose the correct word.*
She _____ not been sleeping well, so she was tired.
Options: **has** / **was** / **had** / **have**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each form to its use.

1. had been + -ing _____
2. had + past participle _____
3. was/were + -ing _____
4. have been + -ing _____

A. a completed action before a past point
B. an action continuing until now
C. an action continuing before a past point
D. an action in progress at a past moment

37 Match the beginning to the ending.

1. She was tired because _____
2. They were wet because _____
3. His eyes hurt because _____
4. I was hungry because _____

A. I hadn't been eating
B. she had been running
C. it had been raining
D. he had been reading

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38 Match the time expression to the sentence.

1. for two hours _____
2. since 9 a.m. _____
3. all day _____
4. how long _____

A. How long had you been driving?
B. She had been cleaning all day.
C. He had been working since 9 a.m.
D. We had been waiting for two hours.

39 Match the question to the answer.

1. Had you been sleeping? _____
2. How long had she been waiting? _____
3. What had they been doing? _____
4. Why was he angry? _____

A. For twenty minutes.
B. They had been playing.
C. He had been waiting for hours.
D. Yes, I had.

40 Match the tense to its example.

1. past perfect continuous _____
2. past perfect _____
3. past continuous _____
4. present perfect continuous _____

A. I was working.
B. I had been working.
C. I have been working.
D. I had worked.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 I was tired because I had been work all day.
Correct word: _____

42 She had been wait for an hour. Correct word: _____

43 They has been playing for hours. Correct word: _____

44 We have been walking for hours when we found the hotel.
Correct word: _____

45 It had been rain all night. Correct word: _____

46 She had been working there since five years.
Correct word: _____

47 I had been studied all day. Correct word: _____

48 They had been live in Rome for a year. Correct word: _____

49 We had been talk for an hour. Correct word: _____

50 I had working all morning. Correct word: _____

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Past perfect continuous

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** had been working	Past perfect continuous shows the cause.
2	**a)** had been waiting	Duration before a past moment.
3	**d)** had	Use had + been + verb-ing.
4	**b)** had been raining	Past perfect continuous explains a past result.
5	**b)** He had known her for years.	'Know' is a state verb: no continuous.
6	**d)** had been cooking	Use had + been + verb-ing.
7	**a)** had been living	Duration before a past moment.
8	**c)** He had been working since 8 a.m.	'Since' + a point in time.
9	**d)** had been walking	The action lasted until the past moment.
10	**a)** the duration of an action	It focuses on how long.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**had been playing**	Had + been + verb-ing.
12	**had**	Had + been + verb-ing.
13	**studying**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
14	**been**	Had + been + verb-ing.
15	**since**	'Since' + a point in time.
16	**for**	'For' + a period of time.
17	**had**	Had + been + verb-ing.
18	**had been reading**	Had + been + verb-ing.
19	**waiting**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
20	**hadn't been sleeping** (or: had not been sleeping)	Negative: hadn't been + verb-ing.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**She had been waiting for an hour.**	Had + been + verb-ing.
22	**They had been playing football all day.**	Had + been + verb-ing.
23	**How long had you been waiting?**	Question: how long + had + subject.
24	**He was tired because he had been running.**	Had been explains the cause.
25	**It had been raining all night.**	Had + been + verb-ing.

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26	**We hadn't been sleeping well.**	Negative: hadn't been + verb-ing.
27	**I had been working since seven.**	'Since' + a point in time.
28	**Had she been crying?**	Question: Had + subject + been.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**had been working**	Cause of a past state.
30	**had been walking**	Duration before a past moment.
31	**had**	Use had + been + verb-ing.
32	**since**	'Since' + a point in time.
33	**had been**	Use had + been + verb-ing.
34	**for**	'For' + a period of time.
35	**had**	Use had + been + verb-ing.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	had been + -ing – an action continuing before a past point; had + past participle – a completed action before a past point; was/were + -ing – an action in progress at a past moment; have been + -ing – an action continuing until now Compare the four forms.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	She was tired because – she had been running; They were wet because – it had been raining; His eyes hurt because – he had been reading; I was hungry because – I hadn't been eating Look for cause and result.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	for two hours – We had been waiting for two hours.; since 9 a.m. – He had been working since 9 a.m.; all day – She had been cleaning all day.; how long – How long had you been driving? Time words guide the form.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	Had you been sleeping? – Yes, I had.; How long had she been waiting? – For twenty minutes.; What had they been doing? – They had been playing.; Why was he angry? – He had been waiting for hours. Answer the question asked.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	past perfect continuous – I had been working.; past perfect – I had worked.; past continuous – I was working.; present perfect continuous – I have been working. Compare the tenses.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**working**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
42	**waiting**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
43	**had**	Past perfect continuous uses 'had'.
44	**had been walking**	The past moment needs 'had been'.
45	**raining**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
46	**for**	'For' + a period of time.
47	**studying**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
48	**living**	After 'been', use verb-ing.
49	**talking**	After 'been', use verb-ing.

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50	**had been working**	Use had + been + verb-ing.

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